Buterin and Durov argue from opposite ends but reach the same conclusion: privacy has to be the default

	Vitalik Buterin, Ethereum	Pavel Durov, Telegram
Why privacy matters	Control over information is power. Privacy protects decentralisation, individual freedom and institutions such as the secret ballot.	Encryption protects everyday communication, personal safety and freedom.
Where it should live	In the protocol: payments, application activity, blockchain queries and network anonymity, with Railgun and Privacy Pools in wallets.	In the product: no backdoors, because access built for authorities also exposes users to hackers.
How far they go	Selective disclosure, so data stays useful while misuse is limited.	Telegram would rather leave a market than add a backdoor.
The gap in practice	A roadmap; adoption depends on wallets and applications shipping it.	Telegram's default Cloud Chats are not end-to-end encrypted; only Secret Chats are.

Where they agree

Privacy has to be designed into the architecture rather than added later, which favours infrastructure built into wallets, chains and messaging over standalone tools.

Sources: Vitalik Buterin, Why I support privacy (Apr 2025); Vitalik Buterin, A maximally simple L1 privacy roadmap; Pavel Durov, statements on encryption and backdoors; Telegram, Cloud Chats and Secret Chats.